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Alan Seeger, an American poet, was born in New York City in 1888 and grew up in a wealthy home. After his father's trading business went bankrupt, his family moved to Mexico City for two years. Its landscape influenced many of his works. Seeger returned to the States and later graduated from Harvard University, where he was inspired by the Romantic poets. Seeger left for Paris, France to live out his romanticized notion of bohemian life and made friendships with many artists. When World War I broke out in 1914, he joined the French army as a volunteer to defend his beloved France. During the war, he wrote a poem, I Have a Rendezvous with Death, about a soldier accepting his upcoming death and it made Seeger instantly famous when it was published. Seeger died during the Battle of the Somme in 1916. Following his death, the French Military awarded him the Croix de Guerre, the highest French military honor.